

Paper Directions 29 — my read (Sep 2, 2026)

Source: `transcripts/20260902_Paper_Directions_29_otter_ai_transcript.docx` (~24:51)
Context: Charles walked Alex through **dirty tenure porch** (BDP + early HERO framing) same day as this call.
Prior: `PD28_notes.md` · tenure porch: `../3-Master_Plan/re_entry/HEROs_and_PASSes/tenure_sandbox/`

Headline

- Two parallel mandates:
1. **Tenure** — Alex likes assortment on the porch; gives **new locks** on decision-year cohort, cumulative career pubs rate, and **pond** (department) construction.
 2. **Paper by end of semester** — **50/50** next week: data progress + **paper-talk outline** (claims + figures + gap slides). Not another month in data-only mode.
- Alex (tenure):** “Cumulative is correct... only look at those people in the fifth or sixth year... up or out — exactly like the army.”
Alex (paper): “Organize the **paper talk** — big question, figure, one-to-two sentence conclusion.”

Transcript arc

Block	Time	Content
Porch review	00:04–03:30	Overlap → high assortment ✓; censored = scrape gap; ALL-PS BDPs; promoted-with-zero annual pubs → need cumulative
Tenure locks	03:45–12:43	Yr ~6 decision; cum pubs ÷ career length; first-pub start; pond = whole dept at decision year; master authorxyear table
Framing	05:21–06:44	Alex adopts “ pond ” (big fish / small pond) vs “team”
New domains	14:21–16:39	League of Legends table sent; NCAA FB→NFL in progress
Paper / time	16:39–23:54	End-of-semester target; F-HERO still on Charles’s MBB list; paper talk outline deliverable ~1 week; 50/50 split

Alex ask — tenure (PD29 locks)

#	Lock	Detail
T1	Decision cohort	Typical tenure ~ year 6 (allow slight early/late). Up-or-out in that year — army-like.
T2	HERO rows	Only assistant-years with decision signal (tenured or out), not every assistant-year.
T3	Own performance $\hat{A}$	ALL-PS · mean · own pubs at decision year = cum pubs ÷ (focus_year – first_pub_year). Field: <code>pubs_per_career_year</code> in career master. Not LAST-PS cum (that’s a stock slice, not Alex’s rate). Career start = first publication year (OpenAlex).
T4	Pond peer context	All faculty in department in the decision year (for LOO / homophily). Not “cohort that arrived with me.” Not every deptxyear in history — only years where someone has a decision.
T5	Data spine	Master table: every OpenAlex ID ever scraped × pubs in each calendar year → precompute running cum / rates; slice for analysis.
T6	Homophily (open)	May use all faculty in dept for assortativity — people join departments, not arrival cohorts.

Porch reaction (same call): Interval overlap H_sort reads **high**; censored mass understood (should shrink as scrape fills); dirty data OK for exploratory pass.

Alex ask — paper & time (next ~1 week)

#	Deliverable	Shape
P1	Paper talk outline	PowerPoint logic: question → figure → 1–2 sentence claim per slide; not generic IMRaD
P2	Gap slides	Blank / placeholder slides for open questions the narrative still needs
P3	Data status	Where scrape sits; tenure rebuild plan vs current v0
P4	Time budget	50/50 data vs outline (Charles picks days or half-days)
P5	MBB F-HERO	Still Charles’s cross-domain “same trend?” check — Alex wants end-of-semester quality , not minimal three-domain ship

Intro / lit review explicitly **de-prioritized** vs narrative of claims.

New domain — League of Legends (**Legends**)

PD29: Alex sent esports table — dev league → pro promotion; team swapping; own + team performance columns.

Repo layout (Charles, Sep 2):

Path	Role
<code>datasets/legends/lol_big_fish_player_split_panel.csv.zip</code>	Raw panel from Alex (PD29)
<code>legends/</code> (future)	Scripts / pipeline (mirror <code>tenure/</code> , <code>sports/</code>)
<code>3-Master_Plan/re_entry/HEROs_and_PASSes/legends_sandbox/</code> (future)	Porch + HERO outputs

Naming rule: use **Legends** (not `lol` , `esports`) for folders, sandboxes, and script prefixes when we add code — same pattern as `tenure` , `sports` , `talent` .

Status: Zip in place (~66k rows, 84 cols); unzip when scaffolding porch / HERO.

Also incoming: NCAA football → NFL (~300 draftees/yr; position-specific) — path TBD.

Delta vs current tenure v0

See `TENURE_hero_pipeline.md` § PD29 delta and `_DISPOSABLE_tenure_hero_thread.md` .

COMPASS read: Sep 2 porch + deck = **Act I exploratory** (Alex approved direction). **Act I-b** = implement PD29 spine before new HERO claims are paper-grade.

Thread log

Date	Entry
2026-09-02	PD29 ingested; tenure locks + paper 50/50 + legends folder convention.